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interact with humans to answer questions and display vocalised keywords. These are becoming popular among all other chatbots, as they assist users just by recognising the voice. Some popular examples are Google Assistant, Siri and Amazon Alexa.

Informational bots. Informational bots provide essential information just by drawing information from its internal or external data to help users with an appropriate answer. Users can set their travelling calendars, get live sports scores, weather reports and a lot more information from such informational bots. Examples include Cricbuzz, Cricket next, Google Alerts and so on.

Conversational bots. Conversational bots are of various types. These communicate with humans—some are led by humans, while others lead humans. These bots have a variety of conversational styles and forms. Businesses have begun to set up conversational bots for such activities as marketing, sales, company calendars and more, which save time and cost. One example is Facebook Messenger.

There are many more types of bots already in play and many will soon emerge in the future, and will make the market digitally more forward.

Chatbots provide round-the-clock service—interactive conversations with an automated program are operational 365 days a year, 24 hours a day. New-age consumers desire immediate results and lean on businesses that deliver high-speed services. Majority of consumers do not care who is responding as long as they get quick help and assistance.

Consumers are not the only ones who have benefitted from chatbots. In fact, businesses are also saving money as chatbots allow prompt resolution of basic customer queries. In addition to cost savings, chatbots have reduced workload of humans and allowed them to focus on creating new ideas/products, instead of spending time resolving clients' concerns.

Chatbots and the future of digital world

Almost every business has streamlined into the digital world. Being a

part of the digital transformation, they have started implementing trending functions into chatbots. Anything offline takes time and effort, and results are not uniform.

Every business seeks technologies that can make client interaction easy and trouble-free. Artificial intelligence (AI)-driven chatbots are one of the best options. These can help with sales communication, maintain calendars, give sport-related updates, and other statistics, besides performing many other duties.

Bots have developed tremendously. These serve many purposes in contemporary businesses by making interactions effective and productive.

According to Gartner, chatbots will power 85 per cent of all consumer service interactions by 2020. In addition, these are expected to proliferate automotive companies to act as car manuals. Once a consumer purchases a car, the chatbot would contact them via text message, email or other channel preference, and list out tasks including stereo setup, oil checkup, etc, while being ready to answer real-time questions.

Another prediction is in the area of HR, wherein employees will be able to seek information regarding their on-boarding and off-boarding.

Tax filing companies are also expected to implement chatbots to make the process of filing taxes friendlier. Questions may be asked or step-by-step guidance may be provided for complex filings.

In conclusion

Progress in deep learning and NLP will increasingly allow chatbots to offer responses based on understanding rather than mere programming. This advancement will form the essence of future marketing applications. A turning point going forward will be better incorporation of sentiments and emotions for smooth and accelerated consumer service interactions. Therefore it would be prudent for marketers to constantly update their chatbot strategies to stay ahead, by offering refined strategies for consumer engagement. Today, it would be fair to say that this bot-driven system is the imminent future for all modern-day business needs. **EFY**